The Morshead–Bailey report of 1913 had not only suggested but had even demonstrated that a small party of men could get across Poshing-la and drop down directly into Dirang Dzong bypassing Se-la completely. Once the Chinese got across Poshing-la, the track to Thembang was wide open and they could set up road blocks and cut off the Bomdila–Dirang Dzong road.

On their way to join 48 Brigade, 5 Guards under the command of Lieutenant Colonel Jai Singh was still at Missamari when orders were received to send a platoon immediately to Dirang. The platoon, commanded by Captain Amarjeet Singh, reported to 4 Division HQ on the evening of 4 November. It was told to move without any delay to Poshing-la (11,950 feet), which was the last geographical barrier in the event of Chinese troops infiltrating through that route. However, owing to a shortage of porters and ponies, the patrol consisting of one officer, one JCO and thirty-five other ranks could only move out on 6 November. While the patrol had enough rations to sustain itself for ten days, each man was carrying only pouch ammunition.

On 8 November, the patrol was marooned short of Poshing-la as the porters and ponies deserted the group. Wireless contact was made with Division HQ and Amarjeet asked for reinforcements and additional supplies. The next day, the Guards had made contact with four sections of Assam Rifles that were dug in at Tungri, 5,000 feet south of the pass. By 11 November, the Guards patrol started to prepare its defences astride the pass, leaving the Assam Rifles where they were to act as the firm base.

By 14 November, the rest of 5 Guards had moved up to Bomdila from where a JCO and another fifteen men were dispatched to Tungri along with some porters and ponies laden with additional supplies. Around the same time, Captain Amarjeet Singh decided to proceed further north towards Tse-la (15,600 feet) on a reconnaissance. The route from Poshing-la towards the north meant crossing Pang-la (12,950 feet) and Kya-la (12,500 feet) which is stony and desolate country, making the journey extremely difficult. After crossing Kya-la, the party began to climb towards Tse-la through small scrub covered terrain. However, the Chinese spotted the patrol and laid an ambush. On 15 November, the patrol walked into the trap and was cut down by the Chinese.

Four survivors made it back to Poshing-la. Their return coincided with the arrival of the resupply column from Bomdila. Hot on the heels of the